

Shubhanginee Singh, PhD

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I am a Postdoctoral Research Fellow at the School of Humanities, Tallinn University, where I am working on my project *Memory, Everyday Bordering Experiences and Tourism* (MEET). The project is supported by the Mobilitas Incoming Postdoctoral Grant awarded by the Estonian Research Council (ETAG) within the framework of the Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions Postdoctoral Fellowship (MSCA-PF) programme. Previously, I was working as an Assistant Professor at National Law University Odisha, India, with academic specialization in citizenship and border studies, and focused on identity and resource politics, infrastructure development, and governance issues.

APPOINTMENTS

Research Fellow, Centre for Landscape and Culture, Tallinn University 2025–Present

My current research examines tourism as a territorialisation strategy of the Indian state in the Eastern Himalayan borderlands. Drawing on recent ethnographic fieldwork in Tawang, Arunachal Pradesh, I am developing a project on what I call *atmospheric bordering* — the agency of air, altitude, and terrain in shaping high-altitude leisure and battlefield tourism at the India–China border. A complementary strand of the work examines the role of memory politics in the state’s recent battlefield tourism initiatives.

Assistant Professor, Political Science, National Law University Odisha, India 2023–2025

Assistant Professor (Visiting), Political Science 2022–2023

Dr. B.R. Ambedkar National Law University, India. Taught Political Theory, Indian Political Thought, Western Political Thought, and Indian Politics.

EDUCATION

PhD, Political Science, Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi 2018–2024

Thesis: *Governing Borderlands: State, Communities, and Border Management in Arunachal Pradesh*.
Advisor: Prof. Anupama Roy.

M.Phil., Political Science, Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi 2016–2018

Dissertation: *Differentiated Citizenship in the Protected Areas of Northeast India: A Study of Arunachal Pradesh*. Advisor: Prof. Anupama Roy. Grade: 78.8%.

M.A., Political Science, Kirori Mal College, University of Delhi 2014–2016

Grade: 60.2%.

B.A. (Hons), Political Science, Miranda House, University of Delhi 2011–2014

Grade: 69.5%.

AWARDS AND HONOURS

- Incoming Postdoctoral Grant, Estonian Research Council, under the MSCA-PF framework (2025).
- UGC–DAAD Indo-German Partnership Scholarship, for attending the summer school at the Institute of Political Science and Sociology, University of Würzburg, Germany (2018).
- UGC Junior Research Fellowship (JRF/SRF), during M.Phil. and PhD (2016–2024) for research support.
- University Rank Holder, B.A. (Hons) Political Science, Miranda House, University of Delhi (2011).

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- Singh, S. (2025). Possibilities for Peaceful Borders: Territory, Mobility, and Identity. In *Oxford Intersections: Borders*, OUP (under review).
- Singh, S. (2025). Urban Landscapes and Memory — A Review of *Competing Memories of European Border Towns*. *Journal of Borderlands Studies* (forthcoming).
- Singh, S. (2024). The Politics of Belonging in Arunachal Pradesh: Rules of Exclusion and Differentiated Citizenship. *Asian Ethnicity*, Routledge, 1–26. <https://doi.org/10.1080/14631369.2024.2383931>
- Singh, S. (2023). Border Humanitarians: Gendered Order and Insecurity on the Thai-Burmese Frontier. *Journal of Borderlands Studies*, Routledge, 39(2), 381–383. <https://doi.org/10.1080/08865655.2023.2289126>
- Singh, S. (2022). Development Strategies of the Indian State in the Himalayan Borderlands of Arunachal Pradesh. *Journal of Asiatic Society for Social Science Research*, Vol. 4, Issue 2.

BOOK CHAPTERS

- Singh, S. (2025). Between Two Giants: The Transformation of the Governance Landscape of Arunachal Pradesh. In *Contours of Democracy in New India* (ed. Pratick Mallick), Routledge, London & New York. DOI: 10.4324/9781003714668-7.
- Singh, S. (2019). Land and Rules of Exclusion. In *Northeast India: Exploring Philosophy, Culture, and Environment Sustainability*, ed. Sonia Mehta & Anna Senrung, Krishi Sanskriti Publications. ISBN 978-93-85822-90-2.

PUBLIC WRITING

- Singh, S. (2022). Straddling the Border in the Himalayan Borderlands. *LiveWire, The Wire*. livewire.thewire.in
- Singh, S. (2022). Lives Lived at the Borderlands of Arunachal Pradesh. *Countercurrents*. countercurrents.org

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- “Atmospheric Bordering: Preliminary Ethnographic Notes on High-Altitude Tourism in Tawang.” Workshop on *Unsettling the Volatile and Volumetric Borderlands*, Eur-Asian Border Lab, Tallinn University.
- “Between Geopolitical Turbulence and Resilience: The Shifting Spectrum of Peaceful Borders in Arunachal Pradesh.” *Ireland–India Conference*, Dublin City University, 2026.
- “Border Monumentalization and Fractured Solidarities: Spiritual Tourism as Territorialization in the Eastern Himalayas.” *AAS-in-Asia Conference*, 2026 (upcoming).
- “Remembering Sacred Ecologies: Memory, Development, and Resistance in Eastern Himalayas.” *Memory Studies Association Conference*, Buenos Aires, July 2026 (upcoming).
- “Boundaries and Belonging in the Himalayan and Patkai Borderlands.” *Third South Asian Border Studies Conference*, Banaras Hindu University, 17–19 April 2023.
- “Constructing the Frontier: State Making and Development Strategies in the Himalayan Borderlands of Arunachal Pradesh.” *International Conference on Himalayan Studies*, Association for Nepal and Himalayan Studies, Toronto, Canada, 13–16 October 2022.

- “Transition of Arunachal Pradesh from Frontier to Border.” *Borderland Futures: Technologies, Zones, and Co-existences*, Asian Borderlands Research Network, Seoul, South Korea, 23–25 June 2022.
- “Inner Line Regulation and Politics of Indigeneity.” *Change and Continuity in South Asia: Unpacking Identity, Security and Technology*, King’s India Institute Graduate Conference 2021, June 2022.
- “Inner Line Permit and Contemporary Contestations.” National Seminar on *Public Policy, Governance and Development in the North-Eastern States*, Department of Political Science, North-Eastern Hill University, Shillong, March 2019.
- “Land and Rules of Exclusion in Arunachal Pradesh.” International Conference on *North East India: Exploring Philosophy, Culture & Environment Sustainability*, Department of Philosophy, Daulat Ram College, University of Delhi.
- “Indian State in the Neoliberal Era: Transition from Welfare State to Security State.” International Conference, Satyawati College, University of Delhi.

INVITED AND DEPARTMENTAL TALKS

- “Where is the Border? A Framework for Analyzing the Intersection of Memory, Geopolitics, and Everyday Bordering.” MKK Seminar Series, Centre for Landscape and Culture, Tallinn University, September 2025.
- “Boundaries of Belonging: Citizenship and Exclusion in Arunachal Pradesh.” Fortnightly Seminar Series, School of Social Sciences, CHRIST (Deemed to be University), Delhi NCR Campus, August 2025.
- “Differentiated Citizenship: The Politics of Belonging and Rules of Exclusion in Arunachal Pradesh.” Faculty Seminar Series, National Law University Odisha, July 2024.

WORKSHOPS ATTENDED

- Online workshop on Oral History, organised by the Department of History, Jesus and Mary College, University of Delhi, 1 November 2025.
- Ten-day Faculty Development Workshop on Research Methodologies, National Law University Odisha, November 2024.
- Five-day Faculty Development Workshop, National Law University Odisha, 15–19 November 2023.
- Two-day workshop “Un-bordered Futures: De-Constructing and Reimagining Borders,” Jadavpur University, 14–15 December 2023.
- Three-day workshop “Talking Himalayas: Disciplinary Approaches and Methods in Border Studies,” Ashoka University.
- Course on German Politics, Institute of Political Science and Sociology, University of Würzburg, Germany, July 2018.
- Summer School on “Analysing Quantitative Research Techniques in Indian Politics,” organised by Lokniti.